

# Wei Hou

Updated September 3, 2026

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| Research interests                                                                                      | Empirical corporate finance, labor-market institutions, corporate governance, firm organization                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| Education                                                                                               | <b>School of Economics, Erasmus University</b>                                                                               | Rotterdam, Netherlands                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|                                                                                                         | Ph.D. in Finance                                                                                                             | 2023 – 2027 (expected)                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|                                                                                                         | <b>University Carlos III of Madrid (UC3M)</b>                                                                                | Madrid, Spain                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|                                                                                                         | Mphil in Business and Finance                                                                                                | 2021 – 2023                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|                                                                                                         | <b>Tilburg University</b>                                                                                                    | Tilburg, Netherlands                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Working Paper                                                                                           | Msc in Finance                                                                                                               | 2019 – 2021                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|                                                                                                         | <b>Nankai University</b>                                                                                                     | Tianjin, China                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|                                                                                                         | Bsc in Business Administration                                                                                               | 2015 – 2019                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>On the Program: A Gender Equality Initiative and Professional Visibility at Academic Conferences</b> |                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| With Marina Gertsberg, Esad Smajlbegovic, Daniel Urban, and Patrick Verwijmeren.                        |                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <i>Revise &amp; Resubmit, Research Policy</i>                                                           |                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |

*Abstract:* Persistent gender disparities characterize scientific careers. We study a gender equality initiative implemented at a leading academic conference, a key stage in researchers' careers where visibility, reputation, and professional networks are shaped. Using a difference-in-differences design that compares two major conferences within the same discipline, we show that a time-limited initiative encouraging the appointment of women as paper discussants led to a sharp but temporary increase in female representation in this prestigious role. The increase did not come at the expense of quality: female discussants on the conference program during the initiative had stronger publication records and comparable expertise-paper matches. The initiative increased female representation across the seniority distribution, with the largest gains among senior women, where pre-initiative underrepresentation was most severe. Senior women also took on a disproportionate number of conference roles. Over time, the pool of selected women broadened modestly to include scholars from lower-ranked institutions, and matched evidence is consistent with subsequent recognition gains for both senior and junior women. Our findings show that leadership-driven gender equality initiatives can meaningfully alter representation in high-profile academic roles, but that their effects are not necessarily self-sustaining.

*Presentations:* ESE Cheapthrills 2024, TU Munich 2025, University of Melbourne 2025, FBA Conference 2025

### **Noncompete Agreements and Internal Labor Markets**

*Presentations:* Tinbergen Institute Jamboree, ESE Cheap Thrills, Spanish Finance Forum PhD Day, Corporate Finance Day 2026 (scheduled), FMA 2026 (scheduled), and 7th RCF-ECGI Conference (scheduled)

*Abstract:* This paper studies how labor mobility restrictions shape firms' internal allocation of human capital. Exploiting staggered state-level variation in noncompete agreement (NCA) enforceability and matched employee-level data from Revelio Labs, I show that tighter restrictions increase internal promotions, with effects concentrated among workers in operations- and production-related functions and knowledge workers. Organizational hierarchy also adjusts: small establishments add hierarchical layers and extend career ladders, while large establishments become flatter. At the firm level, NCA-sensitive firms increase assets and SG&A per employee. I provide evidence that hold-up alleviation and internal tournament incentives drive these patterns. Together, the findings show that NCAs reshape the organizational structures through which firms develop and allocate human capital.

Publication

### **Ranking finance conferences: An update**

with Esad Smajlbegovic and Daniel Urban

*Journal of Empirical Finance*, 2025

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| Journal Referee     | <i>Review of Managerial Science</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Teaching experience | <b>Thesis Supervisor, Department of Business Economics</b> 2024–2027<br>FEM11067: Master’s Thesis Financial Economics<br>FEB13100: Bachelor Thesis<br>Supervise master’s and bachelor’s theses<br><br><b>Teaching Assistant, Department of Business Economics</b> Fall 2024–2027<br>FEM11118: Advanced Corporate Finance and Governance<br><i>Average course rating: 8.5/10</i><br><i>Average student rating: 4.4/5</i> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Honors and Awards   | National Beca Scholarship-Government of Spain 2021–2022<br>National Beca Scholarship-Government of Spain 2022–2023<br>CentER Research Assistance Honors, Tilburg University 2020<br>University Scholarship, Nankai University 2018                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Presentations       | ESE Cheapthrills, ESE Research Retreat 2024<br>Seminars at University of Melbourne, Tinbergen Jamboree Seminar, TU Munich 2025, FBA Conference 2025, ESE Research Retreat<br>PhD Seminars at RSM, PhD Workshop at 33rd Spanish Finance Forum, Tinbergen Jamboree Seminar, ESE Cheapthrills, 23rd Benelux Corporate Finance Days, 7th RCF-ECGI, FMA 2026 2026                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Skills              | <b>Programming</b><br>Proficient in: R, Stata, LaTeX, Python.<br><br><b>Languages</b><br>Mandarin (native), English (proficient)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| References          | <b>Patrick Verwijmeren</b><br>Professor of Finance<br>Erasmus University Rotterdam<br>Erasmus School of Economics<br><a href="mailto:verwijmeren@ese.eur.nl">verwijmeren@ese.eur.nl</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | <b>Daniel Urban</b><br>Associate Professor of Finance<br>Erasmus University Rotterdam<br>Erasmus School of Economics<br><a href="mailto:urban@ese.eur.nl">urban@ese.eur.nl</a><br><br><b>Marina Gertsberg</b><br>Assistant Professor (Senior Lecturer) in Finance<br>University of Melbourne<br><a href="mailto:mgertsberg@unimelb.edu.au">mgertsberg@unimelb.edu.au</a> |